UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2011

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **(Exam date : 12.06.2011)** **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

• Indus Valley Civilization & Vedic Civilization

1. Regarding the Indus Valley Civilization, consider the following statements:

1. It was predominantly a secular civilization, and the religious element, though present, did not dominate the scene.

2. During this period, cotton was used for manufacturing textiles in India.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): The religious outlook of the Indus Valley civilization was primarily idyllic and customary. In this civilization, there is evidence of worship of many animals, birds, vegetation, trees etc., along with the worship of the Mother Goddess and the male deity. The Indus valley people knew the first knowledge of the method of growing cotton. The Greeks named it 'Sindon'.

2. The ''dharma'' and ''rita'' depict a central idea of ancient Vedic civilization of India. In this context, consider the following statements:

1. Dharma was a conception of obligations and of the discharge of one's duties to oneself and to others.

2. Rita was the fundamental moral law governing the functioning of the universe and all it contained.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only

(b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2

(d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): The Rigveda, whose reign was from 1500 BC to 1000 BC. The word 'dharma' relates to morality. The meaning of 'Rita' is the moral and material system of the world.

• Buddhism, Jainism, Bhagavata, Shaiva and Other Religion

3. The Jain philosophy holds that the world is created and maintained by -

(a) Universal law (b) Universal Truth

(c) Universal Faith (d) Universal Soul

Ans. (a) : Jain philosophy believes that the whole world is made up of two continual and independent elements called Jiva and Ajiva. Jiva is a "living substance" or sentient, while Ajiva is an "inanimate substance" or insentient. Here, Jiva means individual soul and not the universal soul. According to Jainism, souls are many and creatures live in every particle of the universe. Therefore, according to Jain philosophy, the creation and maintenance of the universe are done by Universal Law.

• Revolt of 1857 and Mass Movement of 19th Century

4. Which amongst the following provided a common factor for tribal insurrection in India in the 19th century?

(a) Introduction of a new system of land revenue and taxation of tribal products.

(b) Influence of foreign religious missionaries in tribal areas.

(c) Rise of a large number of money lenders, traders and revenue farmers as intermediaries in tribal areas.

(d) Complete disruption of the old agrarian order of the tribal communities.

Ans. (d) : The main reason for the 19th Century tribal movement in India were as follows– (i) The government weakened their traditions by granting zamindar status to the chieftains of the tribes and by implementing the new method of rest. (ii) Infiltration of Christian missionaries by the government in tribal areas, (iii) Among the tribals, a group of Mahajan, Merchants and Revenue Collectors, who were in the role of middlemen, were brought, (iv) To tighten government control in forest areas, banned the use of the forest as fuel & livestock and ban on jhoom and fallow farming.

• Land Revenue Systems in British India/Freedom Struggle and National Movement

5. The tendency for increased Litigation was visible after the introduction of the land settlement system of Lord Cornwallis in 1793. The reason for this is normally traced to which of the following provisions?

(a) Making Zamindar's position stronger vis-a-vis the ryot

(b) Making East India Company an overlord of Zamindars

(c) Making judicial system more efficient

(d) None of the above

Ans. (d) : The Permanent Settlement was an agreement between the East India Company and Bengali landlords to fix revenues to be raised from land. It was concluded in 1793 by the Company administration headed by Charles Earl Cornwallis. The other two systems prevalent in India were the Ryotwari system and the Mahalwari system. The correct option is (d)

6. Which one of the following observations is not true about the Quit India Movement of 1942?

(a) It was a non–violent movement

(b) It was led by Mahatma Gandhi

(c) It was a spontaneous movement

(d) It did not attract the labour class in general

Ans. (b) : The Quit India Movement started on 9 August, 1942. Initially this movement was non - violent. Most of popular leaders were arrested and imprisoned, and movement became leaderless this movement led to the end of British Rule in India.

7. What was the reason for Mahatma Gandhi to organize a satyagraha on behalf of the peasants of Kheda?

1. The Administration did not suspend the land revenue collection in spite of a drought.

2. The Administration proposed to introduce Permanent Settlement in Gujarat.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only

(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (a): At the beginning of 1917 and 1918, Gandhiji participated in three struggles i.e. of Champaran Satyagraha (Bihar), Ahmedabad and Kheda (Gujarat). Gandhiji came to know that the farmers of the Kheda district are in a lot of trouble. The crop is ruined, yet the government is recovering tax from them, the farmers demanded for tax exemption, but the government refused. This was the reason for Mahatma Gandhi to organize Satyagraha.

8. What was the purpose with which Sir William Wedderburn and W.S. Caine had set up the Indian Parliamentary Committee in 1893 ?

(a) To agitate for Indian political reforms in the House of Commons

(b) To campaign for the entry of Indians into the imperial Judiciary

(c) To facilitate a discussion on India's Independence in the British Parliament

(d) To agitate for the entry of eminent Indians into the British Parliament .

Ans. (a): In 1893, the Indian Parliamentary Committee was setup by Sir William Wedderburn and WS Caine to organize an agitation in the House of Commons for political reforms in India.

9. Mahatma Gandhi said that some of his deepest convictions were reflected in a book titled, "Unto this last" and the book transformed his life. What was the message from the book that transformed Mahatma Gandhi?

(a) Uplifting the oppressed and poor is the moral responsibility of an educated man.

(b) The good of an individual is contained in the good of all

(c) The life of celibacy and spiritual pursuit are essential for a noble life.

(d) All the statements (a), (b) and (c) are correct in this context.

Ans. (b) : Mahatma Gandhi had read John Ruskin's book 'Unto this Last' during his stay in Africa. This book changed Gandhiji's life. The message in this book that changed the life of Gandhi was that the welfare of the individual lies in the welfare of all.

10. With reference to Indian freedom struggle, Usha Mehta is well-known for –

(a) Running the secret Congress Radio in the wake of Quit India Movement

(b) Participating in the Second Round table Conference

(c) Leading a contingent of Indian National Army

(d) Assisting in the formation of Interim Government under Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru

Ans. (a) : Quit India movement started on 9 August, 1942; during this movement, secret radio was broadcast by the Congress in many areas of Mumbai. While Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia used to broadcast on this radio, Usha Mehta was a member of a small organization operating underground radio.